

Computing with others

Computers are not just used in isolation. They also allow people to collaborate with colleagues, keep in touch with friends and family, and connect with the world at large.

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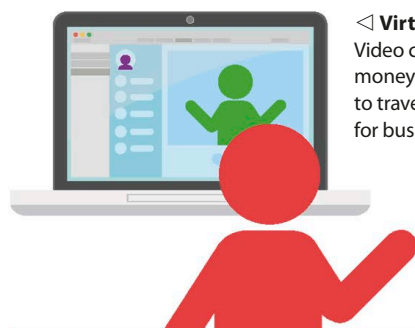
What is social media? 194–195 ▶

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Video calling

There are several applications available that allow users to make video calls. These calls include the video as well as the sound of the callers. Most of these applications don't charge users, but it's good to check. It's also possible to have group calls with several callers in different locations. Sound-only calls are another option for people who prefer not to be seen, or if the video service is slow or jerky.



◀ Virtual travel

Video calls can save time and money by reducing the need to travel to another location for business meetings.

Shared calendars

Online calendars, such as ones provided by Google and Microsoft, are a useful feature for work. They make it easier to set up meetings by showing details of other people's schedules. These calendars can also be used by families to plan events, or by groups of friends to arrange a date and time to meet up.

CALENDAR						
2018						
May						
Mon						Busy
Tue	Busy					
Wed						
Thurs	Busy					Busy
Fri		Busy				
Sat			Busy			

It's possible to set a shared calendar to show when a user is busy.

◀ Time management

Anyone trying to plan a meeting can simply view each person's schedule to figure out the best possible day and time.

Slides

Presentation software allows users to make digital slideshows, including slide transitions and background themes, to accompany their work presentations. The slideshow can be shown by attaching the user's laptop to the screen or projector. Alternatively, the file can be transferred to a dedicated computer via a USB drive or accessed online from a cloud storage service.



◀ Visual aids

Digital slides can act as a prompt during a presentation, and help in displaying visual information, such as graphs.

Making websites

It's not necessary to know how to code to create a website. Many specialist websites allow users to make a site with a graphical editor, similar to a word processor. Some fee-paying sites also include these graphical editors. These sites enable users to build more involved websites with extra features, such as online stores.



◀ Blogging

Blogs are online journals where people write about events or topics that interest them. Other people on the web can read and comment on the articles.